

two of them) – of which one can be used for the root (/) partition and the rest of the space can be further divided to create more partitions. Of this, one can be the Linux swap partition and the rest can be used as desired.

Complications to beware of during installs

If you followed the steps carefully and righteously, there shouldn't be any problems. There, however, are a few nuts and bolts which may be out of place to make your day a nightmare. It's always good to be aware of those before starting off the installation. After all, devils don't warn before striking.

- ▶ **Partitioning problems:** We focus once again on this for this is the most vulnerable point for making a mistake, specially for a person new to Linux.

The solution here is to allow Ubuntu to take the partitioning decisions if you don't understand something.

- ▶ **Boot loader installation problems:** If the boot loader is corrupted, be sure that your system is under a high probability of 'never booting again'. You might have to take a highly complicated way to restore bootloader using either your Windows or Linux recovery disks.

The solution here is to check the CD / DVD for defects before starting the install. Also do check the MD5 or SHA checksums for the ISO images before burning.

- ▶ **Broken packages:** If a package is broken, your system is going to be as well. Once again, if you have asked Ubuntu to download updates while installing and some packages are downloaded broken, you would face one problem or the other. Although Ubuntu makes sure that this doesn't happen, it always pays to be on the safer side.

The solution in this case is to make sure that you have checked the CD / DVD for defects beforehand. If you plan to update the system, we recommend you do it after installation. This saves on the installation time. Since more things can go wrong during installation than later, it's best to update later.

- ▶ **Power supply:** This is something we all understand the criticality of. Do make sure that power doesn't get interrupted while you're installing the system. The worst case here is a power failure when bootloader is being installed.

The solution is simple – get a power supply backup (such as UPS) and make sure it lasts long enough.